

Passages - The Picture of Dorian Gray

There is no such thing as a moral or an immoral book. Books are well written, or badly written. That is all.

The commonest thing is delightful if one only hides it.

Every portrait that is painted with feeling is a portrait of the artist, not of the sitter. The sitter is merely the accident, the occasion. It is not he who is revealed by the painter; it is rather the painter who, on the coloured canvas, reveals himself. The reason I will not exhibit this picture is that I am afraid that I have shown in it the secret of my own soul.

Something seemed to tell me that I was on the verge of a terrible crisis in my life. I had a strange feeling that Fate had in store for me exquisite joys and exquisite sorrows. I grew afraid, and turned to quit the room. It was not conscience that made me do so; it was a sort of cowardice. I take no credit to myself for trying to escape.

None of us can stand other people having the same faults as ourselves.

I have given away my whole soul to some one who treats it as if it were a flower to put in his coat, a bit of decoration to charm his vanity, an ornament for a summer's day.

Nothing can cure the soul but the senses, just as nothing can cure the senses but the soul.

Behind every exquisite thing that existed,

there was something tragic.

Humanity takes itself too seriously. It is the world's original sin. If the caveman had known how to laugh, History would have been different.

"To get back one's youth, one has merely to repeat one's follies."

Nowadays most people die of a sort of creeping common sense, and discover when it is too late that the only things one never regrets are one's mistakes.

Punctuality is the thief of time.

Nowadays people know the price of everything and the value of nothing.

But you should not say the greatest romance of your life. You should say the first romance of your life. You will always be loved, and you will always be in love with love. A grande passion is the privilege of people who have nothing to do. That is the one use of the idle classes of a country.

The people who love only once in their lives are really the shallow people. What they call their loyalty, and their fidelity, I call either the lethargy of custom or their lack of imagination.

Faithfulness is to the emotional life what consistency is to the life of the intellect—simply a confession of failures.

Faithfulness ! I must analyse it some day. The passion for property is in it. There are many things that we would throw away if we were not afraid that others might pick them up.

It is only the sacred things that are worth touching, Dorian.

When one is in love, one always begins by deceiving one's self, and one always ends by deceiving others.

People are very fond of giving away what they need most themselves. It is what I call the depth of generosity.

" I can't believe it. Dorian is far too sensible."

"Dorian is far too wise not to do foolish things now and then, my dear Basil"

One's own life--that is the important thing. As for the lives of one's neighbours, if one wishes to be a prig or a Puritan, one can flaunt one's moral views about them, but they are not one's concern.

I consider that for any man of culture to accept the standard of his age is a form of the grossest immorality.

I should fancy that the real tragedy of the poor is that they can afford nothing but self-denial.

Beautiful sins, like beautiful things, are the privilege of the rich."

No civilised man ever regrets a pleasure, and no uncivilised man ever knows what a pleasure is."

"I know what pleasure is," cried Dorian Gray.

" It is to adore some one."

"That is certainly better than being adored," he answered, toying with some fruits.

" Being adored is a nuisance.

Women treat us just as Humanity treats its gods. They worship us, and are always

bothering us to do something for them."

One should absorb the colour of life, but one should never remember its details. Details are always vulgar.

"Knowledge would be fatal. It is the uncertainty that charms one. A mist makes things wonderful."

Women, as some one says, love with our ears, just as you men love with your eyes, if you ever love at all."

Anything becomes a pleasure if one does it too often

Art has no influence upon action. It annihilates the desire to act. It is superbly sterile. The books that the world calls immoral are books that show the world its own shame. That is all.

It is said that passion makes one think in a circle

He was prisoner in thought. Memory, like a horrible malady, was eating his soul away